

StudyBuddy — Business Plan Overview

1. The Problem & Opportunity

- Algerian university students lack a structured, academic-focused collaboration platform
- Existing tools (WhatsApp groups, Facebook) are informal and unorganized
- No platform connects students by university, major, or subject with built-in academic features
- StudyBuddy fills this gap: a purpose-built academic social network for Algerian students

2. Target Market

- **Primary:** Algerian university students (undergraduate & postgraduate)
- **Secondary:** Professors and teaching assistants seeking student engagement tools
- **Future:** Private prep centers and tutoring schools as institutional clients
- Large addressable market: over 1.7 million university students enrolled in Algeria

3. Business Model — Freemium

- **Free trial:** Full access for the first 2 months after registration
- **Basic tier (free):** Core functionality remains free permanently — no paywalling essential features
- **Premium tier (~250 DZD/month):** Unlocks richer communication and productivity features
- Pricing is intentionally low to remain accessible to students on limited budgets
- Model precedents: Discord, Notion, Telegram Premium

4. Subscription Plans

Feature	Basic (Free)	Premium (~250 DZD/mo)
Posts, comments, voting, search	Yes	Yes
Public & subject rooms	Yes	Yes
Private rooms	Max 5	Unlimited
File sharing (docs, PDFs, images)	Yes, up to 10 MB	Yes, up to 50–100 MB
Voice messages in rooms	No	Yes
Video file sharing	No	Yes
Audio / video calls in rooms	No	Yes (<i>roadmap</i>)
AI-powered tools	No	Yes (<i>roadmap</i>)

5. Planned Premium Features (Beyond Communication)

- **Profile:** Premium badge, custom profile banner, extended activity history
- **Posts:** Longer post limit, post scheduling, full edit history
- **Saved posts:** Organize into folders/collections; export as PDF study digest
- **Rooms:** Activity insights, custom member roles, pinned resources tab, announcement channel

6. Planned AI Features (*Roadmap*)

- **PDF/document summarizer** — upload a course PDF, receive a structured summary
- **Flashcard generator** — auto-generate study Q&A cards from posts or uploaded files
- **Smart search** — search by natural language instead of exact keywords
- **Study plan generator** — input exam dates and subjects, get a weekly study schedule
- **Language assist** — improve academic writing for multilingual users (Arabic / French / English)

7. Estimated Operating Costs (*Theoretical*)

- **Hosting & backend** (e.g., VPS / cloud): ~15–30 USD/month at small scale
- **Database** (Supabase / PostgreSQL): Free tier sufficient for early-stage; paid from ~25 USD/month at scale
- **File storage** (object storage for uploads): scales with user volume, ~0.02 USD/GB/month
- **Email notifications** (e.g., SendGrid): free tier covers thousands of emails/month
- **AI API costs** (e.g., OpenAI / Anthropic): pay-per-use, only activated under premium tier
- **Domain & SSL:** ~10–15 USD/year
- *Total estimated burn at early stage: under 60 USD/month*

8. Revenue & Growth Phases

- **Phase 1 — Launch (months 0–6):** Free for all users; focus on user acquisition and retention
- **Phase 2 — Monetization (months 6–18):** Introduce Premium tier; convert active power users
- **Phase 3 — Institutional (year 2+):** B2B offering for universities and prep centers (dashboards, verified accounts, analytics)
- Even a modest conversion rate (5–10% of active users to Premium) generates sustainable revenue at scale
- B2B contracts represent the highest revenue potential long-term

9. Competitive Advantage

- First platform purpose-built for the Algerian university ecosystem
- Localized: supports the major/university structure specific to Algeria (29 majors mapped)
- Combines social networking, academic collaboration, and platform moderation in one product
- Rating-based trust system and admin architecture are unique differentiators
- Low-cost premium model makes conversion realistic for the target demographic